

How to Make Learning as Addictive as Social Media | Duolingo's Luis Von Ahn | TED

TED

듀오링고가 학습을 SNS만큼 중독적으로 만든 비결

Advanced

12:54

DURATION

160

WPM

234

SEGMENTS

20

VOCABULARY

10

GRAMMAR



[10-Step Study →](#)

stdyLang — AI-Powered Language Learning

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01 Video Structure Overview

This 12-minute video by TED is structured into 9 key sections.

1 Introduction: Personal Background

0:05 ~ 0:53

루이스 폰 안이 과테말라 출신이라고 소개하며, 과테말라와 멕시코 및 미국의 관계를 유머러스하게 설명해요. 가난과 불평등이라는 주제를 설정해요.

2 Education and Inequality

0:53 ~ 1:35

루이스는 교육이 불평등을 해소하기보다 오히려 강화한다고 주장해요. 어머니의 희생 덕분에 좋은 교육을 받고 컴퓨터 과학 박사 학위를 받은 개인적인 이야기를 나눕니다.

3 Why Foreign Languages?

1:37 ~ 3:28

루이스는 듀오링고가 수학이나 컴퓨터 과학 대신 외국어로 시작한 이유를 설명해요. 핵심 이유는 영어 학습이 다른 과목과 달리 소득 잠재력을 직접적으로 높이기 때문이에요.

4 Mobile-First and Freemium Model

3:28 ~ 5:03

루이스는 스마트폰을 교육 전달 플랫폼으로 사용하기로 한 결정과 프리미엄 비즈니스 모델을 설명해요. 부유한 나라의 유료 구독자가 가난한 나라 사용자의 무료 교육비를 효과적으로 부담해요.

5 Competing with Addictive Apps

5:06 ~ 5:56

핵심 과제: 스마트폰에는 틱톡이나 인스타그램 같은 중독적인 앱이 있어요. 듀오링고의 해결책은 같은 심리적 기법을 사용해서 '브로콜리를 디저트 맛이 나게' 만드는 거예요.

6 Technique 1: Streaks

5:56 ~ 6:57

루이스는 연속 사용 일수를 세는 스트릭이 어떻게 매일 참여하게 하는지 설명해요. 300만 명 이상의 듀오링고 사용자가 365일 이상의 스트릭을 가지고 있고, 일본이 평균 스트릭이 가장 길어요.

7 Technique 2: Notifications

7:02 ~ 9:21

루이스는 듀오링고의 알림 전략을 설명해요: AI 기반 타이밍(최적 시간 = 마지막 사용 후 24시간), 7일 비활성 후 중단, 그리고 놀람도록 효과적인 소극적 공격적 작별 알림. 올빼미 마스코트는 밈이 되었어요.

8 The 80-90% Rule

9:21 ~ 11:07

루이스는 교육 앱이 틱톡만큼 몰입하게 할 필요가 없다고 주장해요. 80-90%면 충분하고 내적 동기가 나머지를 채워준다고요. 듀오링고는 현재 미국 전체 고등학교보다 더 많은 언어 학습자를 보유하고 있어요. 스크린 타임이 모두에게 양질의 교육을 전달하는 미래를 그려요.

9 Q&A: Applying to Other Subjects

11:07 ~ 12:54

Q&A에서 루이스는 듀오링고 방식이 반복으로 배우는 과목(읽기, 초등 수학)에 가장 잘 맞는다고 설명해요. 설명이 필요한 콘텐츠에는 칸 아카데미 같은 영상 기반 접근이 필요할 수 있대요.

02 Essential Vocabulary

Core words from the video that are high-value for learners.

addictive /ə'dɪktɪv/

adjective

causing a strong and harmful need to regularly have or do something

중독성이 있는, 빠져들게 하는

Latin 'addictus' meaning 'assigned, surrendered' from 'addicere' (to devote)

ad-

dict (say, declare)

-ive

"Some of the most addictive drugs that humanity has ever engineered."

Related: addiction, addict, addicted

accessible /ək'sɛsɪbl/

adjective

able to be reached, entered, or used by everyone, including those with limited resources

접근 가능한, 이용할 수 있는

Latin 'accessibilis' from 'accedere' meaning 'to approach'

ac-

cess (go, yield)

-ible

"On a mobile phone that was accessible to everyone."

Related: access, accessibility, inaccessible

freemium /'friː miəm/

noun

a business model in which basic services are free while advanced features require payment

프리미엄 (기본 무료, 추가 기능 유료) 모델

Blend of 'free' + 'premium', coined in 2006

free + premium (blend)

"Duolingo uses a freemium model to support itself."

Related: premium, freemium model, subscription

inequality /,ɪn'kwɒləti/

noun

the state of not being equal, especially in status, rights, or opportunities

불평등, 격차

Latin 'in-' (not) + 'aequalis' (equal)

in-

equal (same, level)

-ity

"I always saw it as the opposite, as something that brings inequality."

Related: equal, equality, inequitable

streak /striːk/ noun

a continuous series of events; in apps, a count of consecutive days of use

연속 기록, 스트릭

Old English 'strica' meaning 'a stroke, line'

streak (line, mark)

"One of the most powerful ones is the notion of a streak."

Related: streaky, winning streak, losing streak

consecutively /kənˈsekjʊtɪvli/ adverb

following each other without interruption; in unbroken sequence

연속적으로, 잇따라

Latin 'consecutivus' from 'consequi' meaning 'to follow closely'

con-

secut (follow)

-ively

"The number of days that you've used the product consecutively."

Related: consecutive, consequence, subsequent

engaged /ɪnˈɡeɪdʒd/ adjective

involved and interested in an activity; actively participating

몰입한, 참여하는

French 'engager' from 'en-' (in) + 'gage' (pledge)

en-

gage (pledge)

-ed

"We use them to keep people engaged but with education."

Related: engage, engagement, engaging

sophisticated /səˈfɪstɪkətɪd/ adjective

having a lot of experience and knowledge; highly developed and complex

정교한, 세련된, 복잡한

Latin 'sophisticatus' from Greek 'sophistikos' meaning 'wise, clever'

sophist (wise person)

-icated

"We have a very sophisticated AI system."

Related: sophistication, philosophy, sophomore

passive-aggressive /ˌpæsɪv əˈɡresɪv/ adjective

expressing hostility or resistance indirectly rather than openly

소극적 공격적인, 은근히 공격적인

Latin 'passivus' (enduring) + 'aggressivus' (attacking)

passive (enduring) + aggressive (attacking)

"Passive-aggressive. Works for my mother, works for Duolingo."

Related: passive, aggressive, assertive

redistribution /ˌriː dɪstrɪˈbjuːʃən/ noun

the act of distributing something again or in a different way, especially wealth

재분배

Latin 're-' (again) + 'distributio' (a dividing up)

re-

distribut (divide, spread)

-ion

"It is a small form of wealth redistribution."

Related: distribute, distribution, redistribute

gamify /ˈɡeɪmfaɪ/ verb

to apply game-design elements to non-game contexts to make them more engaging

게이미피케이션하다, 게임화하다

English 'game' + '-ify' (to make)

game

-ify (to make)

"You can actually gamify and turn into something like Duolingo."

Related: gamification, game, gameplay

predominantly /prɪˈdɒmɪnəntli/ adverb

mainly; for the most part

주로, 대부분

Latin 'praedominari' from 'prae-' (before) + 'dominari' (to rule)

pre-

domin (rule)

-antly

"Countries in which people are predominantly learning English."

Related: predominant, dominate, dominant

notification /ˌnɒtɪfɪˈkeɪʃən/

noun

a message or alert sent to inform someone of something

알림, 통지

Latin 'notificatio' from 'notificare' meaning 'to make known'

not (know)

-ification

"Another important mechanism to get people to come back to your product are notifications."

Related: notify, notice, notable

mascot /ˈmæskɒt/

noun

a person, animal, or object believed to bring good luck, used as a symbol for a group

마스코트, 상징 캐릭터

French 'mascotte' meaning 'lucky charm', from Provençal 'masco' (witch)

masco (charm, witch)

-ot

"Our green owl mascot has given up on them."

Related: symbol, icon, emblem

repetition /ˌrɛpɪˈtɪʃən/

noun

the act of doing or saying something again; repeated practice

반복, 되풀이

Latin 'repetitio' from 'repetere' meaning 'to do or say again'

re-

petit (seek, aim at)

-ion

"Subjects that are learned through repetition."

Related: repeat, repetitive, repertoire

subscribe /səbˈskraɪb/

verb

to arrange to receive a product or service regularly by paying in advance

구독하다, 가입하다

Latin 'scribere' from 'sub-' (under) + 'scribere' (to write)

sub-

scrib (write)

-e

"You can also pay to subscribe to turn off the ads."

Related: subscription, subscriber, prescribe

motivation /,moʊtɪ'veɪʃən/ noun

the reason or desire for acting or behaving in a particular way

동기, 동기 부여

Latin 'motivus' from 'movere' meaning 'to move'

mot (move)

-ivation

"Will be provided by people's internal motivation."

Related: motivate, motive, motor

03 Additional Vocabulary

Supplementary words that appear in the video and are useful for expanding your vocabulary.

zeitgeist /'zaɪtgaɪst/ noun

the defining spirit or mood of a particular period of history

시대정신, 시대의 분위기

German 'Zeit' (time) + 'Geist' (spirit)

Zeit (time) + Geist (spirit)

"Duolingo has entered the zeitgeist."

Related: spirit, era, culture

humongous /hju: 'mʌŋgəs/ adjective

extremely large; enormous

엄청나게 큰, 거대한

American English slang, likely a blend of 'huge' + 'monstrous' or 'tremendous'

huge + monstrous (blend)

"You run into a humongous problem."

Related: enormous, gigantic, colossal

prominently /'prɒmɪnəntli/ adverb

in a way that is easily noticeable or stands out

눈에 띄게, 두드러지게

Latin 'prominere' meaning 'to jut out, project'

pro-

min (project, jut)

-ently

"You put it very prominently in your product."

Related: prominent, prominence, eminent

04 Grammar Patterns

Key grammar structures used in the video. Each pattern includes real examples.

Comparative structure: Just like A, B...

Used to draw a parallel between two similar situations. 'Just like' introduces a familiar scenario to explain an unfamiliar one.

'Just like A, B...' 구조는 두 가지 비슷한 상황을 비교할 때 사용해요. 익숙한 상황을 먼저 제시해서 낯선 상황을 설명하는 표현이에요.

Just like the U.S. doesn't want illegal immigration from Mexico, Mexico doesn't want illegal immigration from Guatemala.

Present perfect: have/has + past participle (experience/result)

Used to describe actions completed at an unspecified time that have present relevance. Emphasizes result or accomplishment rather than timing.

현재완료(have/has + 과거분사)는 과거에 완료된 행동이 현재와 관련이 있을 때 사용해요. 시점보다 결과나 성취에 초점을 맞춰요.

We've been able to do this.

Duolingo has entered the zeitgeist.

Conditional: If + present simple, can/will + verb

Used to express a real or likely condition and its result. The 'if' clause sets up the condition, and the main clause describes the consequence.

'If + 현재시제, can/will + 동사'는 실현 가능한 조건과 그 결과를 표현할 때 사용해요. 'if' 절이 조건을 세우고, 주절이 결과를 설명해요.

If you don't pay, you may have to see an ad at the end of a lesson.

If you really want to deliver education to everyone, you have to make it accessible.

Whereas + contrasting clause

Used to introduce a contrasting fact or situation. It highlights the difference between two ideas within a single sentence.

'Whereas'는 대조되는 사실이나 상황을 소개할 때 사용해요. 한 문장 안에서 두 가지 아이디어의 차이를 부각시켜요. '반면에'로 해석해요.

Whereas with languages, if you were a waiter and you learned English, now you can be a waiter at a hotel.

When you're learning something, you get meaning out of it, whereas when you're scrolling for two hours on Instagram, you feel like you just wasted your time.

Not only A, but also B

Used to add emphasis by presenting two related ideas where the second is more important or surprising. Often used in persuasive speech.

'Not only A, but also B'는 두 가지 관련된 아이디어를 제시하면서 두 번째를 더 강조할 때 사용해요. 설득적인 연설에서 자주 쓰여요.

Not only do you have to make it accessible, but also you have to make it so that people want to actually learn.

It turns out that + clause (revealing information)

Used to introduce a surprising or previously unknown fact. It signals that what follows may contradict expectations.

'It turns out that'은 놀라운 사실이나 이전에 몰랐던 정보를 소개할 때 사용해요. 뒤에 오는 내용이 예상과 다를 수 있음을 알려 줘요.

It turns out that the vast majority of the revenue for Duolingo comes from people who pay to subscribe.

It turns out that the algorithm for choosing what time to send you a notification is pretty simple.

The reason (for/that/why) is (that/because)...

Used to explain why something is the case. A direct and clear way to state a cause or justification.

'The reason (for/that/why) is (that/because)...'는 이유를 설명할 때 사용해요. 원인이나 정당성을 직접적이고 명확하게 제시하는 방법이에요.

The reason for that is because English can truly transform your life.

The reason people come back every day is because, well, if they don't come back, that number resets to zero.

Gerund as subject: V-ing + verb

Using a gerund (verb + -ing) as the subject of a sentence. This is common in formal and semi-formal English.

동명사(동사 + -ing)를 문장의 주어로 사용하는 구조예요. 격식체와 반격식체 영어에서 흔히 사용돼요.

Delivering education over a smartphone is like hoping that people will eat their broccoli.

Giving equal access to education to everyone.

Even if/though + concession clause

Used to acknowledge a potential obstacle while maintaining that the main point still holds. Expresses resilience or determination.

'Even if/though'는 장애물을 인정하면서도 주요 주장이 여전히 유효하다는 것을 보여줄 때 사용해요. '~하더라도'라는 의미예요.

Even if you're not as engaging as those apps are, you can still get hundreds of millions of people to use your product.

Even though I didn't grow up rich.

Relative clause with where/which/that

Used to add essential information about a noun. Relative clauses with 'where', 'which', and 'that' modify nouns and provide more context.

관계절(where/which/that)은 명사에 대한 필수적인 정보를 추가할 때 사용해요. 명사를 수식하면서 더 많은 맥락을 제공해요.

A future in which screen time is not a bad thing.

Countries in which people are predominantly learning English.

That is where Guatemala is.

05 Connected Speech & Pronunciation

Natural pronunciation patterns found in the talk. Practice these to sound more natural!

Reduction (축약)

want to → 워너

/wɒnə/

'want to'가 자연스러운 발화에서 'wanna' /wɒnə/로 축약돼요. 'want'의 /t/와 'to'의 /t/가 합쳐지고 단순화되는 거예요.

'원트 투'라고 또박또박 발음하지 말고, '워너'처럼 부드럽게 이어서 발음해 보세요.

going to → 거나

/ɡɒnə/

'going to'(미래를 나타냄)가 일상 대화에서 'gonna' /ɡɒnə/로 축약돼요. /ɪŋ t/ 자음군이 크게 단순화되는 거예요.

'고잉 투'라고 발음하지 말고, '거나'처럼 자연스럽게 축약해서 발음해 보세요.

a lot of → 얼라러브

/ələʊdəv/

'a lot of'가 자연스러운 발화에서 크게 압축돼요. 'lot'의 /t/가 'of'의 모음 앞에서 탄설음 /d/가 되고, 'of'는 /əv/로 축약돼요.

'어 롯 오브'라고 또박또박 발음하지 말고, '얼라러브'처럼 빠르게 이어서 발음해 보세요.

Linking (연음)

think of it as → 씹커비래즈

/θɪŋkəvɪtæz/

네 단어가 연속적으로 연결돼요: 'think'의 /k/가 약화된 'of' /əv/로, 'it'의 /t/으로, 'as'의 /æz/로 이어져 전체가 하나의 단위처럼 흘러요.

'씹크 오브 잇 애즈'라고 끊지 말고, '씹커비래즈'처럼 하나로 이어서 발음해 보세요.

run into a → 러닌투어

/rʌnɪntu: ə/

'run'의 /n/이 'into'의 /ɪ/와 자음-모음 연결을 통해 이어지고, 'into'의 /u:/가 'a'의 /ə/와 자연스럽게 연결돼요.

'런 인투 어'라고 끊지 말고, '러닌투어'처럼 부드럽게 이어서 발음해 보세요.

Elision (탈락)

doesn't want → 더즌원

/dʌzn wɒnt/

'doesn't'의 마지막 /t/가 'want'의 /w/ 앞에서 자주 탈락해요. 파열음 뒤에 또 다른 자음이 오면 발음되지 않는 경우가 많아요.

'더즌트 원트'에서 /t/를 생략하고 '더즌원'처럼 바로 이어 발음해 보세요.

most ways → 모스 웨이즈

/moʊs weɪz/

'most'의 마지막 /t/가 'ways'의 /w/ 앞에서 탈락하는 경우가 많아요. 파열음이 다른 자음 사이에 있을 때 생략되는 경향이 있어요.

'모스트 웨이즈'에서 /t/를 빼고 '모스 웨이즈'처럼 자연스럽게 발음해 보세요.

Assimilation (동화)

did you

→

디쥬

/dɪdʒə/

'did'의 /d/와 'you'의 /j/가 구개음화를 통해 합쳐져서 /dʒ/ 소리가 돼요. 'you'가 /jə/로 축약된 후 동화돼요.

'디드 유'라고 따로 발음하지 말고, '디쥬'처럼 /d/와 /j/를 합쳐서 발음해 보세요.

06 Signal Expressions

Key phrases used to structure the content. Learning these helps you follow presentations.

"So, I'm from Guatemala. This is a public service announcement."

"And a lot of people talk about education as something that brings equality"

"Oh, by the way, this is what I want to talk to you about today"

"And let me tell you why"

"However, if you're trying to deliver education with a smartphone"

"Let me give you some examples of these techniques"

"And this is a really important point, let me say this"

"My hope is that"

"But the single most important thing that I can end this talk with"

"How do you think that you can apply this type of thinking to other subjects?"

Keep Learning!

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youtube.com/watch?v=P6FORpg0KVo